

Partner Portal

Architecture and solution choices

CTO discussion draft
6 October 2026

Proposed direction

Five independently usable services

Marketplace, Floor Plan, Discovery, AI Solution Builder and Multi-Site Designer can use different solutions.

A portal that connects their workflows

Governed product and pricing contracts support a common quote. HubSpot remains the CRM. Existing SSO supplies authentication.

Each application owns access permissions and supports direct entry.

Independent service boundaries

Service	Owned state	Handoff
Marketplace	Selections and comparisons	Canonical product selection
Floor Plan	Plans, placements and simulations	Versioned design and BOM
Discovery	Observations and assessments	Reviewed reuse/replacement
AI Builder	Conversations and grounded proposals	Human-reviewed changes
Multi-Site	Sites, profiles and overrides	Expanded site BOM

Each service needs native access, its own operating owner and a supported exit.

Customer and solution protection

Case	Required boundary
One partner, several customers	A customer grant never extends to another customer
One customer, several collaborators	Each application checks the specific action and resource
Detailed solution state	Isolate files, jobs, AI context, credentials and recovery
Shared commercial information	Classify public products, negotiated prices and internal costs

Topology, policy durations and vendor recovery boundaries remain owner decisions.

Marketplace options

Option	Advantage	Tradeoff / deciding evidence
Thin custom	Precise partner experience	Own catalog tools, permissions and support
Medusa	Reusable commerce foundations	Prove recurring terms, grants and price history
CloudBlue	Channel and subscription scope	Verify purchased scope, rights and integration cost

Compare all three on the same offers, partner prices, revocation and export cases.

Quote authority options

Option	Advantage	Tradeoff / deciding evidence
HubSpot	Existing CRM relationship	Prove entitlement, approvals and proposal fit
QuoteWerks	Specialist quoting with CRM integration	Prove partner SSO, API rights and edit controls
ERPNext	Broader commercial lifecycle	Justify ERP scope and avoid competing masters
Custom	Exact technical and revision controls	Own commercial correctness and maintenance

Evaluate HubSpot and QuoteWerks first. Keep ERPNext conditional on a wider need.

Specialist service options

Service	Alternatives	Evaluation direction
Floor Plan	Hamina/incumbent or custom editor	Specialist proof before custom RF
Discovery	runZero, imports or custom scanner	Compare scoped discovery with import pilot
AI Builder	Managed inference or vLLM	Same quality, privacy and cost tests
Multi-Site	Custom or vendor extension	Compare profile and override semantics

Each option must pass rights, SSO, isolation, handoff and operating gates.

Integration and source ownership

Capability	Proposed contract and responsibility
Product and pricing	One field writer, eligible APIs and governed exports
Package handoff	Versioned source and canonical IDs with scoped receipt
Quote and proposal	One authority owns exact revisions and issued totals
HubSpot adapter	Scoped mappings and a durable reconciliation ledger
Lifecycle and reporting	Minimized projections with source-owned references

Exchange deployment remains open: provider module, adapter or separate service.

Quote integrity and CRM uncertainty

Exact configuration, exact approval

A native CPQ edit that removes required switching or licensing must invalidate technical approval before the quote can issue.

A timeout can hide a successful CRM write

Reconcile the existing command and remote result.
Escalate uncertainty without creating a duplicate.

Future release tests include native edits, price expiry and delayed CRM visibility.

First-use security and operations

Exposure	Evidence before use
Synthetic development	Fabricated data, restricted scope and exact teardown
Real identities or customer data	Accepted grants, data policies and named operators
Files, imports and AI fetching	Quarantine, resource limits and controlled network access
Support and recovery	Attributed access, isolated restore and revoked-grant replay

Each service passes its gate before exposure. Later hardening cannot replace it.

Phased delivery with evidence gates

Phase	Planned outcome	Exit evidence
P0	Scope, authorities and candidate evaluation	Owners, vendor proof and funded work breakdown
P1	Marketplace, quote and HubSpot pilot	Valid quote, reconciliation and isolated recovery
P2	Independent thin service workflows	Native access and safe package handoffs
P3	Specialist and lifecycle/report extensions	New capability scope, exit and operating proof

Calendar commitments follow re-estimation. Each first-use gate also applies within phases.

Pilot scope and proposed exclusions

Thin pilot includes	Expansion needs separate scope
Eligible offers and selection	Human battle-card and resource experiences
Calibrated planning and supported handoff	Non-Wi-Fi planning and specialist accuracy
Seed technical rules and quote integrity	GPU, SD-WAN, IoT and additional rule families
Selected lifecycle/report slices	Complete customer lifecycle and report suite

Product and Cleber must accept narrowed scope or fund its expansion.

Estimate and ownership inputs

133 historical seed person-days

Expanded acceptance needs new task sizing.
The earlier program envelope was a different, unreconciled scope.

A credible plan needs accountable capacity

Include vendor lead times, commercial stewardship, security, service operations and ongoing support in the funding decision.

No current calendar, budget or numerical reliability commitment.

EA review and implementation gates

Status	Meaning for this proposal
EA v2: five blockers remained	Isolation, lifecycle, vendors, quote integrity and first use
Author revision supplied	Design and backlog corrections await exact-commit review
SSO ownership resolved in design	Provider acceptance and runtime evidence still pending
Implementation approval pending	Separate user and applicable owner/Security gates

No blocker waiver or accepted exception is recorded in this deck's source baseline.

Decisions for the CTO discussion

Accountable people for commercial, data and service ownership

Pilot users, data, countries and included capabilities

Evidence required to select vendors and commercial authorities

Capacity and cost inputs for a funded delivery plan

Implementation waits for EA review and explicit scope approval.

Appendix: comparable vendor proof

Candidate group	Common deciding demonstration
Marketplace	Same 20 offers, distinct partner prices, revocation and export
Quote authority	NRC/MRC, approvals, 60 sites, expiry and native edit bypass
Planning / Discovery	Known source fixtures, lost fields and authorized scope
AI / Multi-Site	Grounded/revoked-access cases and repeatable profile changes

Evidence labels: documented, demonstrated, contractual, unknown or failed.

Appendix: three-year ownership cost

Cost component	Inputs still required
Initial work	Implementation, integration, migration and assurance
36 months of operation	Licenses, cloud, support, stewardship and operators
Lifecycle costs	Upgrades, regression proof, export and exit
Low / base / high scenarios	Named seats, assets, API volume, inference and manual labor

No monetary winner can be declared without contractual prices and owner-supplied rates.

Appendix: pending owner decisions

Decision group	Accountable roles	Before
Isolation and lifecycle	Product, Security, data owners	Topology or real data
Commercial and vendors	Commercial, Catalog, Solutions	Selection or configuration
CRM and SSO	CRM admin, SSO and app owners	Registration / integration
Runtime and package provider	Platform, Delivery, Technical lead	Deployment / package use
Lifecycle / inventory scope	Product, data and affected iTop owner	Expanded persistence / reporting

OD-01–OD-10 retain exact gates. Named acceptance and policy values remain pending.